Samantha Andrus-Henry

WRITING STUDIES / LITERACY / VISUAL RHETORIC

Teaching and Scholarly Profile

I am a writing teacher, researcher, and mixed-media paper artist interested in how people make meaning with language, images, materials, and technology. My work centers on reading and writing instruction in open-access education, with attention to the knowledge students bring from their workplaces, languages, families, and communities. I bring experience in composition, multilingual instruction, online mentoring, curriculum development, and assessment, alongside a continuing interest in visual rhetoric, user experience, and document design.

Education

University of Utah | 2026–present
Doctoral student, Writing and Rhetoric Studies
Research interests: literacy studies, reading and writing pedagogy, and visual rhetoric.

Western Governors University | 2014
M.Ed., Instructional Design

Michigan Technological University | 2002–2006
Doctoral study, Rhetoric and Technical Communication; ABD, degree not completed
Concentrations: composition, philosophy, education, and technology.

Northern Arizona University | 2002
M.A., English
Concentrations: rhetoric, composition, and English education. Thesis: “Legality to Practicality: Unsettling Rhetorics of Child Visitation Language.”

Weber State University | 1995
B.S., History
Minors: English and athletic coaching.

Teaching Interests

First-year and intermediate composition; developmental writing; integrated reading and writing; reading studios and reading-process instruction; multilingual writing; technical and professional communication; visual rhetoric and multimodal composition; document design; online and hybrid writing pedagogy; writing across the curriculum.

College Teaching and Student Mentoring

University of Utah | 2026–present
Graduate Teaching Assistant; Instructor of Record, WRTG 2010
Teach undergraduate writing through composition, rhetorical analysis, and critical inquiry. Design lessons and Canvas modules, including assignments, grading rubrics, and asynchronous materials that help students navigate course expectations and participate in their learning.

Global LT International | 2009–present

Language Instructor

Teach academic writing, business writing, and business communication to multilingual students and professionals. Develop individualized curricula, document progress, and adapt instruction to learners' linguistic, cultural, academic, and workplace goals.

Weber State University | 2017–2019

Adjunct Faculty, English

Taught concurrent enrollment Composition 1010 and 2010, supporting students' transition into college writing and research.

Utah State University | 2010–2017

Adjunct Instructor

Taught Composition 1010 and 2010 and Humanities Ideas 1320 in face-to-face, distance, and concurrent enrollment settings. Developed curricula emphasizing digital literacy, writing across disciplines, and critical thinking.

Western Governors University | 2010–2017

Course Mentor and Student Mentor

Taught and advised online learners in English, communication, and information technology programs. Provided individualized writing instruction, academic planning, progress monitoring, and support with time management. Used Salesforce to document mentoring and led university-wide mentor training sessions.

Grand Valley State University | 2006–2010

Visiting Professor

Taught writing, communication, gender studies, research methods, theory, and capstone courses. Contributed to curriculum committees and interdisciplinary humanities programming; advised student productions of The Vagina Monologues.

Grand Rapids Community College | 2007–2008

Adjunct Instructor

Taught developmental writing and Women's Studies, emphasizing critical reading, rhetorical analysis, and active learning. Led faculty workshops connecting feminist theory with writing and classroom practice.

Finlandia University | 2004–2006

Adjunct Instructor

Taught first-year composition, advanced composition, and college skills.

Michigan Technological University | 2002–2006

Graduate Instructor, Adjunct Instructor, and Research Assistant

Taught first-year composition, writing-intensive humanities, introductory philosophy, and student success courses. Mentored English Education student teachers, coordinated tutoring programs, and helped organize CWIC, ECAC, and FemRhet conferences. Assisted Heidi Bostic with translation research on Luce Irigaray's The Way of Love.

Northern Arizona University | 2000–2002

Graduate Instructor and Coordinator

Taught introductory and advanced composition. Mentored new instructors in teaching seminar and supported electronic communication across the curriculum, WAC/WID, and the STARR early-start summer reading and composition program. Coordinated The Conference at the Peak.

School and Community Teaching

UpWard Spiral Publishing & Graphic Design LLC | 2024–present
Owner and Instructor
Produce handmade books and stationery and teach workshops in bookbinding, marbling, papermaking, and bullet journaling. Design learning activities and manage curriculum, client relationships, marketing, and business operations. This making practice informs my research on literacy as craft.

Tooele County School District | 2017–2019
Concurrent Enrollment and Language Arts Teacher
Taught high school and concurrent enrollment English 1010 and Humanities Ideas 1320. Used project-based and trauma-informed approaches; mentored Sterling Scholars and founded and advised an LGBTQIA+ student club.

Prescott High School | 2004–2006
English Teacher and Standards Coordinator
Led school-wide Writing Across the Curriculum work, collaborated with teachers on curriculum and assessment, and coordinated testing. Worked with Arizona educators on standards and cut scores; helped lay the groundwork for a student-led writing center.

Fremont High School, Weber School District | 1996–2000
History Teacher
Taught U.S. and world history; coached women's cross country and track. Served as junior class and Model UN advisor and assistant debate coach.

Upward Bound, Weber State University | Summer 1992
Instructor
Taught history and geography.

Research and Writing in Progress

Literacy as Craft

One interconnected research project with three distinct manuscripts in preparation. The project examines reading and writing as material, embodied, social practices and asks how classrooms can recognize the intellectual labor in students' making. It connects close attention to texts with visible processes, peer exchange, and access to the tools and conditions needed for learning.

The Problem Is Not That Students Are Not Reading

Reading as Craft, Patch-Reading, and the Visibility of Meaning-Making. Develops patch-reading and crafted reading notes as ways to make rereading, interpretation, and revision visible. Examines reading studios, layered annotations, reading maps, and peer discussion as practices for teaching reading alongside writing.

Craft Is Not Easier Work

Making Academic Labor Visible in Two-Year Colleges and Open-Access Institutions. Examines how institutional definitions of rigor can overlook the intellectual work in making, translating, repairing, and arranging. Argues for recognizing students' embodied, multilingual, community, and workplace knowledge in academic literacy instruction.

Literacy as Craft Framework

Conceptual manuscript developing craft as a framework for literacy: texts as made things; literacy as technē; visible labor; distributed meaning-making; material proximity; circulation; and solidarity. Investigates how shared making supports peer learning, collective knowledge, and responsibility to others.

From Course Architecture to Course Pathways

Rethinking Canvas Navigation in Writing Instruction. Presentation and article project in preparation. Uses rhetorical and document-design analysis, a twelve-code framework, cross-case synthesis, and a single-screen material walkthrough of a hybrid first-year writing course to examine how students navigate relationships among projects, weekly modules, resources, and composing spaces.

Develops "pathway architecture" to distinguish productive composing complexity from avoidable coordination work. Proposes an "If / Then Also" approach connecting pedagogical choices with responsibilities for navigation, critical access, and learner agency.

Financial Literacy and Literacy Studies

Developing dissertation and book project bringing financial literacy into conversation with literacy studies. Examines money, documents, institutional systems, and classroom economies through literacy sponsorship, with attention to the material costs of participating in education.

Community College Preparation and Professional Learning

MLA Summer Institute on Reading and Writing Pedagogy at Access-Oriented Institutions, 2026.

University of Utah graduate-level coursework completed: WRTG 7700, Reading and Writing at Access-Oriented Institutions, summer 2026 (Christie Toth and Darin Jensen); WRTG 6050, Online Writing Pedagogy, spring 2026; WRTG 6350, Composition Theory and Research, spring 2026; WRTG 6600, Literacy Studies and Composition, fall 2025.

Current graduate coursework, fall 2026: WRTG 6200, Introduction to the Field; WRTG 7740, Rhetoric I; WRTG 7760, Rhetoric, Composition, and Discourse (Rhetorical Activism and Solidarity); WRTG 7840, Writing 2010 Colloquium.

Additional University of Utah study, 2024–2026: typography, mapping, visual language, digital photography, painting, creative writing, art history, and family economic issues. Noncredit study includes papermaking, botanical dyes, bookbinding, and hand lettering.

Technology and Document Design

Digital teaching and learning: Canvas course organization, asynchronous learning materials, online mentoring, distance instruction, electronic portfolios, and learning management systems, including Blackboard. M.Ed. preparation in instructional design connects course goals, learning activities, and assessment.

Information design and professional communication: Research-based resources, policy briefs, standardized datasets, dashboards, and information hubs. Experience translating complex educational and regulatory information for students, educators, and community organizations.

Visual rhetoric and user experience interests: Reader-centered document organization; typography and visual hierarchy; accessible navigation; visualizing research and reading processes; multimodal feedback; the relationship between the material form of a text and how people use it.

Creative technologies and materials: Digital photography, typography, handmade books, paper-based composition, and workshop design. Interests include connections between physical and digital reading, publication, and learning environments.

Portfolio work includes branding icons, campus wayfinding concepts, room placards, window-cling concepts, and the Eccles Night on the Town theater project, alongside notebooks, photography, and mixed-media artwork.

Research and Professional Experience

Utah System of Higher Education | 2025–2026
State Authorization Reciprocity Agreements Research Intern
Researched professional licensure requirements across 50 states. Developed standardized datasets and documentation to support student mobility and translated regulatory findings into an interactive dashboard and information hub for nursing students, faculty, and institutional audiences.

University of Utah Financial Wellness Center | Spring 2025
Administrative Assistant
Supported financial literacy programming, outreach, peer mentoring, and office operations. Assisted with HEFWA conference planning and led joint writing and theory workshops with UC Berkeley's Center for Financial Wellness.

Davis County School District | 2025
Special Education Behavioral Aide
Supported K–3 students with behavioral and learning differences. Implemented individualized plans and collaborated with teachers, counselors, and families.

United Way of Salt Lake / Hinckley Institute | 2024
Community Schools Research Intern
Conducted national research for the Community Schools Information Hub. Authored and organized educational resources and policy briefs for community use; documented progress and collaboration in Salesforce.

U.S. Department of Defense, Tooele Army Depot | 2020–2024
Munitions Specialist
Trained and certified in demilitarization and munitions maintenance. Served as point of contact for presses and range operations and supported compliance and operational safety.

Courses Taught

Course names are grouped by area; appointments and teaching contexts appear in the experience sections.

Composition and Writing

Composition 1010 and 2010; freshman and advanced composition; developmental writing; essay writing; academic writing; business writing; scientific writing; Writing 305; research and analysis composition; media, technology, and composition.

Reading and Student Success

College Skills; Student Success; early-start college reading and composition support; developmental writing and individualized academic support.

Communication and Humanities

Research Presentation and Speech; Humanities Ideas 1320; Communication Capstone; Communication Research Methodologies; Communication Visions and Cultures; History of Communication Technologies; Theories of Communication; Non-Verbal Communication; Argument and Analysis; Communication Critical Interpretations; Introduction to Philosophy; writing-intensive humanities; Women's Studies; The Rhetoric of Sexuality.

Secondary and Community Education

Concurrent enrollment composition and humanities; AP English; speech; U.S. and world history; geography; bookbinding; papermaking; marbling; bullet journaling.

Curriculum Development and Professional Service

Curriculum and assessment: Writing Across the Curriculum leadership at Prescott High School; WAC/WID and electronic communication across the curriculum at NAU; Arizona AIMS standard-setting work; student completion and learning resources committees at WGU; diversity and liberal studies committee work at Grand Valley State University.

Faculty learning and mentoring: New-instructor mentoring at NAU; English Education student-teacher mentoring at MTU; university-wide mentor training at WGU; workshops on writing, feminist theory, group work, visual rhetoric, and classroom technology.

Editorial service: Reviewer, *Community Literacy Journal*, 2009; advisory board member, *The St. Martin's Guide to Writing*, 9th edition, 2009; reviewer of "Remembering an Event," *The St. Martin's Guide to Writing*, 8th edition, 2008.

Student and community engagement: LGBTQIA+ club founder and advisor, Tooele County School District; faculty advisor, *The Vagina Monologues*, Grand Valley State University; Middle Canyon Land Trust committee work; graduate conference organization and student advocacy.

Certifications and Training

Mental Health First Aid, 2025; FERPA training, 2025; CPR and First Aid, 2025; distance learning and ELL teaching certification. Additional workplace training includes defensive driving (2025) and food handling (2024).

Publications and Other Writing

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Imagining Graduate Students: Understanding Technologized Communication Practices Online." *Fostering Effective Student Communication in Online Graduate Courses*, edited by Bethany Simunich et al., IGI Global, 2018, pp. 271–297.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Say Yes: Reading Infographics in the English Classroom." *The Utah English Journal*, vol. 45, no. 1, 2017, p. 4.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Resiliency and Interdependency at WGU." Western Governors University White Paper, 2012.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Deepening Literature: Incorporating Rhetoric, Composition, and Discourse Analysis into High School English." *Language Arts Journal of Michigan*, vol. 24, no. 1, 2008, p. 16.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Girls." *In Our Own Words*, vol. 6, no. 1, Grand Valley State University Women's Center, Mar. 2008, p. 5.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "This Is Not Your Grandmother's English Class." *The Grand Rapids Press*, 22 July 2007, p. F1.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Connor's P.E. Teacher." *The Friend*, July 2007. Short story purchased.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Using Pivot Tables in English Class and in Assessment." *Connections: News of the Arizona English Teachers Association*, vol. 5, no. 4, Spring 2005, pp. 8–9.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha, and Thomas Henry. *A Reference Guide of Common Ambiguous Terms in Rhetoric and Composition for the New Graduate Student in Mostly Plain, Understandable and Accessible English*. 2002.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Man Made." *Metaphor*, Weber State University, 1995.

Andrus-Henry, Samantha. "Smart Women" and "Summer Warmth." *Metaphor*, Weber State University, 1992.

Presentations and Workshops

Faculty Workshops and Professional Presentations

"Collaborating Professionally." Delta Zeta, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 22 Nov. 2009.

"Working Together: Teaching Group Work Skills in the Classroom." 9th Annual Lilly Conference on College and University Teaching, Traverse City, Michigan, 24–27 Sept. 2009.

"LGBTQIA+ Issues in Education." Grand Valley State University, Pew Campus, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 30 May 2009.

"Bringing Body to the Story: Visualizing Rhetorical Devices." Grand Valley State University, Allendale, Michigan, 14 May 2009.

"Writing Your Vagina Story." VAG Conference, Grand Valley State University, Allendale, Michigan, 23 Nov. 2008 and 6 Dec. 2009.

"Teaching and Using Luce Irigaray in the Classroom." Grand Rapids Community College, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 15 Feb. 2008.

"Teaching and Using Hélène Cixous in the Classroom." Grand Rapids Community College, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 18 Jan. 2008.

"Teaching Vocabulary Actively." Grand Valley State University, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 19 Jan. 2008.

"Teaching and Using Julia Kristeva in the Classroom." Grand Rapids Community College, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 7 Dec. 2007.

"Understanding Arizona Teacher Perspectives on AIMS English and Writing Cut Scoring Process: A Report to the Board." State Board of Education, Phoenix, Arizona, May 2005.

"Writing Across the Curriculum: How to Write a Writing Prompt." Prescott High School Faculty In-Service, Prescott, Arizona, Jan.–Feb. 2005.

"What Is AIMS? How Can You Help Your Student Prepare for the AIMS Reading and Writing Tests." Parent Presentation, Prescott High School, Prescott, Arizona, 26 Jan. 2005.

"How to Use Found Poetry and Phrase Collage to Teach Rhetorical Devices and Poetic Strategies Using a Multiple Intelligences Approach." SkyView School, Prescott, Arizona, 2004.

Conference Presentations and Participation

"Say Yes: Reading Infographics in the English Classroom." UCTE Conference, Sept. 2016.

"Situating Group Work: The Material Conditions of Group Work." FaCIT Conference on Teaching, Learning, and Civic Engagement, Central Michigan University, May 2009.

"Reading the Story in Data: Teaching Information Texts." Bright Ideas Conference, University of Michigan, Lansing, Michigan, Apr. 2008.

"Using Rhetoric, Argument, and Writing Across the Curriculum to Boost Student Performance on State Standards Tests." MCTE, Lansing, Michigan, Nov. 2007.

"Writing Her Story in Divorce Visitation Language: Rhetorical Concerns for Divorcing Mothers." Accepted to FemRhet Conference, Columbus, Ohio, Fall 2003.

"Hearing My Own Voice: A Cyborg Mestiza Crosses Between the Lines." Computers and Writing Conference, Purdue University, Lafayette, Indiana, May 2003.

"Prewriting: Writing Me as a Teacher, The Hemingway On-Site Project." Conference on College Composition and Communication, New York, Mar. 2003.

"Legality to Practicality: The Rhetoric of Divorce in Child Visitation Language." Conference on College Composition and Communication, Chicago, Mar. 2002.

"Electr(on)ifying Feminism: Tracing Community, Identity, and the Street." Chair. Conference on College Composition and Communication, Chicago, Mar. 2002.

"Using Poetry as Webtexts in Computerized Composition Classrooms." Northern Arizona University Graduate Conference, Flagstaff, Mar. 2002.

"A Fable for Our Time: The Myth of the Democratic Computer." Accepted to the University of Utah Humanities Graduate Conference, Salt Lake City, Oct. 2001.

"Raising Graduate Assistant Stipends and Providing Healthcare for Graduate Assistants." Board of Regents, Tucson, Arizona, Mar. 2001.

"Using Literary Magazine Poetry as Webtexts in the Computerized Composition Classroom." University of Nebraska Prairie Schooner 75th Anniversary Conference, Lincoln, Oct. 2001.

"Spatial and Temporal Wanderings through a Virtual Landscape: A Practical Pedagogy." Northern Arizona University Graduate Conference, Flagstaff, Mar. 2001.

"Hannibal: Gourmet or Gore-Mania." Northern Arizona University Graduate Conference, Flagstaff, Mar. 2001.

"Legality to Practicality: Child Visitation Language." Northern Arizona University Graduate Conference, Flagstaff, Mar. 2001.

Awards and Honors

Third place, Annual Cindy Matsumoto Historic Preservation Award, "Dog House," 2025.

Finalist, South Salt Lake Art in Public Spaces, 2024.

Western Governors University Excellence in Teaching and University Service Awards, 2010 and 2012.

Young Women Strong Leaders Conference Mentor Nominee, 2009.

Pew Faculty Teaching and Learning Center Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Travel Grants, 2009.

Conference on College Composition and Communication Professional Equity Project Grant, 2009.

Citation from the League of Minnesota Poets for “Memory,” 2008.

Prescott High School received an Excelling School designation, 2005–2006, during my service there (institutional recognition).

Travel Award, Michigan Technological University, 2003.

Travel Award, Northern Arizona University, Fall 2001 and 2002.

Alex Weirich Memorial Scholarship Award, Northern Arizona University, 2001–2002.

Apple for the Teacher Awards, *The Standard Examiner*, 1998 and 2000.

Writers @ Work Poetry Workshop Scholarship, Salt Lake City, July 2000.